

# Simon Lee

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## EDUCATION

### Columbia University, Columbia Business School

New York, New York

*M.S. in Financial Economics*

*Aug 2026 – May 2028*

- **Anticipated PhD Coursework:** Empirical Asset Pricing, Advanced Derivatives, Econometrics and Statistical Inference

### University of California, Los Angeles

Los Angeles, California

*B.S. in Mathematics/Economics, Computing Specialization*

*Sep 2023 – June 2026*

- Graduated in 3 years taking PhD level courses, founding a club, and committing 25 hours weekly to research projects
- **Coursework:** Graduate Machine Learning for Finance, Real Analysis, Graduate Probability Theory, Graduate Monte Carlo Methods for Optimization
- **Awards:** 2023 Washington State Team Problem Mathematics Competition Champion

## RESEARCH & EXPERIENCE

### Empirical Asset Pricing Research

Los Angeles, California

*Researcher*

*Nov 2025 – Present*

- Conduct empirical financial research with a PhD candidate and tenured faculty in UCLA Department of Mathematics
- Analyze historic CRSP and WRDS market data through novel stochastic manifold learning techniques, learning intrinsic geometry of asset characteristic space for downstream pricing strategies
- Build exposure to buy-side alpha research through facets of empirical asset pricing and applications of spectral geometry, stochastic processes, and machine learning within finance

### Lagged Multi-Factor Model Research

Los Angeles, California

*Researcher*

*Feb 2025 – Present*

- Pioneer machine learning-based financial research in direct collaboration with a UCLA Department of Mathematics Postdoctoral Researcher
- Formalize theoretical models on synthetic market data, using orthogonal non-negative matrix factorization and autoencoders to build factor profiles for assets and cluster then accordingly in a lagged multi-factor model
- Gain applicable hands-on machine learning research experience for both industry and academic standards

### Citrix

Seattle, WA

*Software Engineer Intern*

*Jun 2022 – Sep 2022*

- Met remotely several times a week with a team of engineers from varying countries learning about a type of server traffic distribution known as load balancers and their strengths/weaknesses in cloud computing
- Implemented solutions to various real problems that the company had run into pertaining to load balancers through fixing syntax and implementing my own code to complete logical gaps
- Gave monthly presentations to manager on my code implementations and specific ideas and code functionalities pertaining to load balancers

### Serafina Restaurant

Seattle, WA

*Garde (Pantry) Chef*

*Jun 2024 – Sep 2024*

- Worked on a team of seven skilled and established chefs preparing and cooking hundreds of dishes under the pressure of a fast-paced fine dining kitchen mastering time management, execution, and cohesive collaboration

## INVOLVEMENT & LEADERSHIP

### Bruin Algorithmic Traders

Los Angeles, California

*Co-Founder, President and Director of Research*

*Feb 2025 – June 2026*

- Collaborate with other student members on hands-on trading algorithms and projects that translate mathematical tools and ideas into financial models that can be clearly justified and critiqued
- Research focuses on engineering conditional factor models that use non-linear dimensionality reduction techniques, continuing to learn about Quantitative Finance through the lens of algorithmic trading

### UCLA Phi Kappa Psi

Los Angeles, California

*Social and Brotherhood Chair*

*Sep 2023 – June 2026*

- Managed a 30,000+ dollar budget for various social, brotherhood and philanthropy related events

## SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Languages:** Intermediate Python, Java and C++, Beginner R
- **Interests:** Cooking, Waterskiing, Mountaineering, Rubik's Cubes, Long Distance Running, Rock Climbing